The Dramatic Faces of Robin Williams – A Tribute

By Various Authors (See sources after each monologue below)

INTRODUCTION

When Robin Williams died by his own hand in 2014, the world gasped for air, shocked that a man with Williams' gifts could perform an act of such desperation. Williams could make us laugh; but just as powerfully, could sober us up in seconds with some of films' most powerful monologues. This is a tribute to his brilliance and to the amazing legacy he left behind . . . The Dramatic Faces of Robin Williams.

PATCH: You ask me if I've been practicing medicine. Well if this means opening your door to those in need, those in pain, caring for them, listening to them, applying a cold cloth until a fever breaks, if this is practicing medicine, if this is treating a patient, then I am guilty as charged.

TRANSITION

In 1969, a suicidal Hunter Adams voluntarily commits himself to a mental institution. Once there, he finds that helping his fellow inmates gives him a purpose in life. Inspired, he leaves the asylum and vows to become a doctor. "Patch" Adams is determined to find a way to help his patients, even if it means being expelled from medical school. This is his monologue to the review board in Patch Adams by Steve Oedekerk

PATCH: What's wrong with death? What are we so mortally afraid of? Why can't we treat death with a certain amount of humanity and dignity and decency and, God forbid, maybe even humor. Death is not the enemy. If we're going to fight a disease, let's fight one of the most terrible diseases of all, indifference. Now, I've sat in your schools and heard people lecture on transference and professional distance. Transference is inevitable. Every human being has an impact on another. Why don't we want that in a patient-doctor relationship? That's why I've listened to your teachings and I believe they're wrong. A doctor's

mission should be not just to prevent death but also to improve the quality of life. That's why, you treat a disease, you win you lose; you treat a person, I guarantee you win no matter what the outcome. Now here today, this room is full of medical students. [*HE TURNS TO THE STUDENTS]* Don't let them anesthetize you. Don't let them numb you to the miracle of life. Always live in awe of the glorious mechanism of the human body. Let that be the focus of your studies and not a quest for grades which will give you no idea of what kind of doctor you'll become. And don't wait until you're on the ward to get your humanity back. Start your interviewing skills now. Start talking to strangers, talk to your friends, talk to wrong numbers, talk to everyone. *[HE TURNS BACK TO THE COMMITTEE]* I want to be a doctor with all my heart. I wanted to become a doctor so I could serve others. And because of that, I've lost everything, but I've also gained everything. I've shared the lives of patients and staff members at the hospital, I've laughed with them, I've cried with them. This is what I want to do with my life. And, as God is my witness, no matter what you decide today, I will still become the best damn doctor the world has ever seen.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Steve Oedekerk
ISBN: N/A
Publisher: Scriptfly.com
Date (Month/Year): 1998

TRANSITION

You see, life doesn't guarantee a happy ending, just a series of struggles and the occasional moment of grace. It is in these moments, the role and Robin Williams become one. Take, for example, the graduation speech from Jack in 1993. Because of an unusual aging disorder, Progeria, Jack finishes high school at age 18 with the body of an 80-year-old man. Jack by James DeMonaco and Gary Nadeau

JACK: I don't have very much time these days so I'll make it quick. Like my life. You know, as we come to the end of this phase of our life, we find ourselves trying to remember the good times and trying to forget the bad times, and we find ourselves thinking about the future. We start to worry, thinking, "What am I gonna do? Where am I gonna be in ten years?" But I say to you, "Hey, look at me!" Please, don't worry so much. Because in the end, none of us have very long on this Earth. Life is fleeting. And if you're ever distressed, cast your eyes to the summer sky when the stars are strung across the velvety night. And when a shooting star streaks through the blackness, turning night into day... make a wish and think of me. Make your life spectacular. I know I did.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: James DeMonaco and Gary Nadeau
ISBN: N/A
Publisher: Scriptfly.com
Date (Month/Year): 1996

TRANSITION

"But only in their dreams can men be truly free. 'Twas always thus, and always thus will be." Remember Dead Poet's Society? In 1989 Williams portrayed John Keating, an English teacher at a rigid prep school, who inspires a love of learning in his students. Dead Poet's Society by Tom Schulman

MR. KEATING: "We don't read and write poetry because it's cute. We read and write poetry because we are members of the human race. And the human race is filled with passion. And medicine, law, business, engineering, these are noble pursuits and necessary to sustain life. But poetry, beauty, romance, love, these are what we stay alive for. To quote from Whitman, "O me! O life!... of the questions of these recurring; of the endless trains of the faithless... of cities filled with the foolish;

what good amid these, O me, O life?" Answer. That you are here - that life exists, and identity; that the powerful play goes on and you may contribute a verse. That the powerful play goes on and you may contribute a verse. What will your verse be?"

"Boys, you must strive to find your own voice. Because the longer you wait to begin, the less likely you are to find it at all. Thoreau said, "Most men lead lives of quiet desperation." Don't be resigned to that. Break out!" Go on, lean in. Listen, you hear it? - - Carpe - - hear it? - - Carpe, carpe diem, seize the day boys, make your lives extraordinary."

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Tom Schulman
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Date (Month/Year): 1989

TRANSITION

From Dead Poets to life after death. In What Dreams May Come by Ronald Bass, Williams plays Dr. Chris Nielsen. He journeys from Heaven to the depths of Hell to rescue his wife's soul after the death of their two children. In the words of Robin Williams: "Good people end up in Hell because they can't forgive themselves." That's what suicide is all about.

CHRIS: I'm sorry, babe, but there's some things I have to say. I'm sorry for all the things I'll never give you. I'll never buy you another meatball sub with extra sauce -- that was a big one! I'll never make you smile. I just wanted us to be old together, just two old farts laughin' at each other as our bodies fell apart, together at the end by that lake in your painting. That was our Heaven, see? There's lots of things to miss: books, naps, kisses, and fights! God, we had some great ones. Thank you for those. Thank you for every kindness. Thank you for our

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children. For the first time I saw them. Thank you for being someone I was always proud to be with. For your guts. For your sweetness. For how you always looked, for how I always wanted to touch you. You were my life. I apologize for every time I failed you. Especially this one.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Ronald Bass
ISBN: N/A
Publisher: Scriptfly.com
Date (Month/Year): 1998

CONCLUSION

No matter what people tell you, words and ideas can change the world. – Robin Williams

There is a profound wisdom in these monologues. Robin Williams spoke the lines from the depths of his soul; they jumped off the screen and went straight into ours. What made his performances so powerful? Maybe it's because we knew he wasn't acting.

NOTE: All original screenplays can be purchased from Scriptfly.com.

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